



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian School
School Website: <https://trinitychristian.net/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Christian School (Pittsburgh, PA, 15221) presents an evaluation challenge: the school's crawl content accessible in the provided materials is effectively unavailable due to an active Cloudflare server error on the public site (trinitychristian.net), which yields a 500 error and no usable textual material for analysis. Because the Public Materials required to substantiate a Classical orientation (explicit references to Great Books, Trivium, scholé/restful learning, liturgical practice, explicit virtue formation, etc.) are not retrievable from the crawl vectors, there is no textual evidence within the accessible campus materials to support any of the six classical criteria. The only available evidence from the crawl vectors is the presence of an inaccessible site (Cloudflare 500 error), which does not demonstrate religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty portrayal, or parent/community partnerships in a way that can be mapped to the classical rubric. This absence of accessible evidence leads to a NOT CLASSICAL assessment across all six categories when applying the Six Essential Elements framework.

Rationale for this determination rests on the keyword-analysis framework drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) lexicon, which defines Positive and Negative Indicators for each category. Because no site-texted content from the Trinity site is retrievable to match against the Positive keywords (e.g., truth, virtue, Great Books, scholé, liturgy, wonder) or Negative signals, the keyword analysis yields zero matches for both positive and negative indicators across every category, thereby supporting a Not Classical classification in each category. The Positive/Negative keyword framework and its expected signals are documented in the classical-lexicon resource. See the lexicon for the qualifying terms and their intended signals.

Citations indicate the evidence basis: - Site access issue and lack of retrievable public material on Trinity's domain (Cloudflare 500 error) as shown in the crawl record.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Current public materials are not accessible for extraction due to a 500 error; no explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or communal liturgical practice evidenced in retrievable text.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords found = 0; Negative indicators = 0 (no retrievable content to map against). See classicality lexicon for the exact positive/negative indicators.
- Why this rating: Without retrievable text demonstrating transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, liturgical life, or sacred communal practices, the category cannot demonstrate the core classical signals. The absence of accessible content drives the Not Classical rating here.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: No retrievable statements about formation of virtue or pursuit of wisdom over workforce preparation are accessible from the site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0.
- Why this rating: Classical schools articulate formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a telos of true/-good/beautiful; such signals are not present in the retrievable content. Not Classical.
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No retrievable content indicating liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or Great Conversation, nor explicit historical-canonical framing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0.
- Why this rating: Absent explicit Great Books/Trivium signals or a canon-based curriculum in the accessible text, category signals fail to align with classical curriculum indicators.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No retrievable description of Socratic discourse, memory-based recitation, or experiential project-based approaches within accessible site text.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0.
- Why this rating: Absent explicit evidence of contemplative/scholé pedagogy, Socratic seminars, or rhetoric training in the school's publicly available materials.
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No retrievable public-facing statements about faculty as living curriculum, virtuous mentors, or portraits of teacher/student ideals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0.
- Why this rating: Lacking retrievable evidence of the classical faculty archetypes or a formalized "portrait" of teacher ideals.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No retrievable statements confirming parent partnership, parental formation, or open visitation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0.
- Why this rating: Without explicit parent-partnership language or community integration signals in accessible content, the category cannot meet classical indicators.

Aggregate assessment: NOT CLASSICAL

- The aggregate ranking is NOT CLASSICAL, given that none of the six categories could be demonstrated through retrievable site content against the Positive/Negative keyword framework defined in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Note: The public-facing materials for this school could not be accessed in the crawl due to a 500 error, which limited the ability to identify classical signals. The classical-lexicon provides the standard signals for a rigorous comparison, and in the absence of retrievable content, the school cannot be shown to meet the classical criteria across the six categories.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL. If the school's public materials were accessible and aligned with the classical signals, potential needle-moving changes would include:
- Explicitly articulating transcendental moral realism and a theological grounding integrated with curriculum (Element 1).

- Stating a clear telos toward virtue and wisdom, with formation emphasized over mere information (Element 2).
- Documenting a curriculum centered on grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books, and the Great Conversation, with a genuine sense of wonder (Element 3).
- Describing contemplative and Socratic pedagogy, with opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking (Element 4).
- Portraying faculty as living exemplars and mentors, with a well-defined teacher-student ideal (Element 5).
- Demonstrating robust partnerships with parents and a culture of parental formation and open campus visits (Element 6).
- Concrete steps to move toward CLASSICAL (if public materials were updated):
- Publish explicit statements about theological underpinnings and liturgical/community practices (even at a minimal, clearly stated level) aligned with the Positive Keyword signals.
- Articulate a public, public-facing mission focused on virtue and wisdom, not merely job-readiness.
- Present a Trivium-centered curriculum with references to Great Books and the Great Conversation, including historical framing.
- Implement and showcase pedagogy such as scholé, memorization, recital, Socratic seminars, and rhetoric opportunities for upper grades.
- Provide a clear “living curriculum” portrayal of faculty and a defined teacher-student model.
- Establish and highlight formal parent-education initiatives and open-visit policies.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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